

FILM DOSSIER: THE AVENGERS

Phase 1 · Film #8 · PHASE 1 FINALE

Status: ☒ DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

1. IDENTITY

Field	Entry
Film #	8 of 29
Phase	Phase 1 (finale)
Real title	<i>THE AVENGERS</i>
Decoy / codename title	<i>"FAMILY REUNION"</i>
Release date	Friday, May 4, 2012
Distributor	Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures (the first MCU film distributed by Disney)
Director	Joss Whedon
Rating / runtime	PG-13 · 188 minutes (inside the crossover range)
Genre + second genre	Superhero action-adventure + ensemble war film / disaster epic

2. OWNERSHIP

Field	Entry
Whose film / franchise is this?	The ensemble. The Avengers franchise belongs to the team. Marc-Anthony Bullock is billed first because Tony pays for the team and houses it (616).

Character	Actor	Age at release
Tony Stark / Iron Man	Marc-Anthony Bullock	30
Thor / Dr. Donna Blake	Esther Smilley	29
Bruce Banner / The Hulk	Amond Baker	30
Hank Pym / Ant-Man / Giant-Man	Tyler Chapman	30
Janet van Dyne / The Wasp	Elxa Bullock	31
Steve Rogers / Captain America	Tyrese Avery	30 (<i>Steve: physically 24; born 1920</i>)
Pepper Potts	Tayia Boyd	30
Natasha Romanoff / Black Widow (<i>epilogue</i>)	Harmony Divine	29
Claire Barton / Hawkeye (<i>epilogue</i>)	Arianna Cummings	29
Loki	Tom Hiddleston	31
Namor the Sub-Mariner	Tenoch Huerta	31
Rick Jones	Michael Cera	23
Nick Fury	Samuel L. Jackson	63
Edwin Jarvis	James D'Arcy (<i>the only real actor to have played him</i>)	36
Agent Jasper Sitwell	Maximiliano Hernández	38
Mistress Death (<i>post-credit; first credited appearance</i>)	Aubrey Plaza	27
Thanos (<i>post-credit; performance capture on set</i>)	Josh Brolin (✅ <i>the showrunner's pick; Brolin plays Thanos for the whole Infinity Saga</i>)	44
Stan Lee (<i>cameo: a circus-goer who thinks Mechano is "a very convincing robot"</i>)	Stan Lee	89

Accuracy flag: 616's Jarvis is an older WWII veteran who has served the Starks since before Tony was born. D'Arcy (36) is the only real actor to have played him, so per the Casting Rules he keeps the role. Jarvis is written as a younger man who came to the Starks as a teenager and has served the family ever since.

3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

Field	Entry
Primary comic(s) adapted	<i>The Avengers</i> #1 (September 1963), Stan Lee & Jack Kirby, "The Coming of the Avengers!" <i>The Avengers</i> #3 (January 1964): the Hulk quits and joins Namor. <i>The Avengers</i> #4 (March 1964), "Captain America Joins the Avengers!"
Supporting comics	<i>The Avengers</i> #2 (1963, Giant-Man) · <i>The Avengers</i> #16 (1965, set up in the epilogue) · <i>Captain Marvel</i> #33 (1974) and <i>The Infinity Gauntlet</i> #1 (1991), Jim Starlin: Thanos and Mistress Death
Nerf check	✅ The Hulk vs. Thor fight ends even . The Hulk leaves the team because of mistrust , not defeat. Namor fights at full strength and retreats because Cap asks him to , not because he's beaten.

3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

Field	Entry
Overall accuracy score	96%. It adapts <i>Avengers</i> #1, #3 and #4 in order, plot point for plot point.

Straight from the page:

- **Loki, exiled on the Isle of Silence**, uses his **astral form** to get revenge on Thor. He **makes a railroad track vanish** in front of a speeding train. **The Hulk saves the train and is blamed for wrecking it** (#1).
- **Rick Jones** and his ham-radio friends, the **Teen Brigade**, send out a call for help. **Loki reroutes it to Thor**, but **Iron Man, Ant-Man and the Wasp pick it up too** (#1).
- **The Hulk hides in a circus disguised as "Mechano the Robot"** (#1). Yes, really.
- Thor chases Loki to Asgard. **Ant-Man and the Wasp trap Loki in a lead-lined container**, and Thor sends him back to exile (#1).
- **The Wasp names the team**: "It should be something colorful and dramatic... like 'the Avengers!'" (#1)
- **Hank Pym becomes Giant-Man** (#2).
- **The Hulk quits**, since his teammates don't trust him, and **joins Namor** against the Avengers. **The battle at Gibraltar** (#3).
- **Namor** comes across people **worshipping a figure frozen in ice** and throws the block into the sea. **It drifts into the warmer Gulf Stream and thaws**, and **the Avengers' submarine picks up Captain America**. He wakes up shouting "**Bucky!**" (#4)
- **Cap joins the Avengers** in the Hulk's place (#4).
- **Tony gives the team 890 Fifth Avenue, Avengers Mansion**, with **Edwin Jarvis** running it (616).

Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| Rick's radio call goes out to "**any hero out there**" instead of the Fantastic Four | The FF haven't been introduced in the MCU yet. Their debut is kept for their own film in Phase 2. |

| #1, #3 and #4 (September 1963 to March 1964) happen within about five weeks | The MCU calendar |
 | Cap and Namor's WWII history as Invaders is played up | It pays off the *Captain America* montage |

POWERS & ABILITIES

Character	616 powers & abilities	Shown in this film	Held back (why)	Match
Iron Man (Mark V)	Every system from Marks III and IV, upgraded	Flies alongside Thor, catches the train with the Hulk, dives deep against Namor	Later armors	✓ 100%
Thor	God-level strength; Mjolnir's full powers	Fights the Hulk to a standstill ; calls down a hurricane at Gibraltar	God Blast, Odinfence	✓ 100%
The Hulk	Limitless strength that grows with rage	Catches a derailing train ; trades blows with Thor evenly; tears through the Avengers' defenses at Gibraltar	–	✓ 100%
Ant-Man / Giant-Man	Shrinking, ant control; growing to 12+ feet with full proportional strength (<i>Avengers</i> #2)	Debuts as Giant-Man ; wrestles the Hulk; traps Loki at ant size	Heights of more than 100 ft (616 later)	✓ 100%
The Wasp	Flight, stings, shrinking; tactician	Sting blasts at Loki's trolls; designs the plan to trap Loki	Leading the team (616 later)	✓ 100%
Captain America	Peak human; the shield; a tactical genius	Wakes up and within the hour is leading the team against Atlantis	–	✓ 100%
Loki	Sorcery, illusions, astral projection, shape-shifting	Astral projection from the Isle of Silence, a train-sized illusion, turning into a hawk	–	✓ 100%
Namor	Superhuman strength (class 75–100), flight, amphibious; stronger when wet ; commands Atlantis's armies	Hurls a warship; flies; fights Thor and Giant-Man together in the sea	–	✓ 100%. Namor retreats because Cap asks him to, not because he's beaten.
Thanos	(<i>post-credit only</i>)	Seen and heard	Everything else (Phase 2 and 3)	✓

4. STORY

Field	Entry
Logline	A god's revenge brings Earth's mightiest heroes together by accident. What keeps them together is a choice, and at the bottom of the ocean they find the man who will lead them.
Theme	Assembly. Heroes are strong alone and unstoppable together. The hardest part is trust .
Villain / antagonist	Loki (Acts 1 and 2); Namor , with the Hulk (Act 3)

What the movie is about

ACT ONE: THE COMING OF THE AVENGERS

- **The Isle of Silence.** Loki's astral form leaves his chained body and searches Midgard for a weapon to use against Thor. He finds **the Hulk** (the *Thor* post-credit scene pays off).
- **The Arizona desert, Monday, March 19, 2012.** A railroad track **disappears**. The Hulk **catches the train**, and the news reports that he wrecked it.
- **Rick Jones** defends him over his ham radio: *"Any hero out there, please..."*
- Loki redirects the call to **Dr. Donna Blake**, and **Iron Man, Ant-Man and the Wasp** also pick up the signal.
- The heroes meet in the desert as strangers. They find the Hulk **hiding in a traveling circus as "Mechano the Robot."** It's the funniest set piece in Phase 1, and it turns into a four-way brawl.
- **Thor sees Loki's trick for what it is** and goes after him to Asgard.

ACT TWO: ASSEMBLED

- In Asgard, Loki's trolls and illusions hold off Thor. On Earth, **Ant-Man and the Wasp** work out where Loki's astral form will come back to Earth.
- They lure Loki into a **lead-lined trap** at ant size. Thor sends him back to the Isle of Silence.
- In the desert, five exhausted heroes stand together. Iron Man says they work well as a team. **The Wasp: "It should be something colorful and dramatic... like 'the Avengers'!"**
- **Avengers Mansion.** Tony gives the team **890 Fifth Avenue**. **Jarvis** serves tea. **Fury** arrives with a charter and a S.H.I.E.L.D. liaison, and **the Avengers Initiative** becomes real.
- **Hank debuts as Giant-Man.**

ACT THREE: THE MAN IN THE ICE

- The team doesn't trust the Hulk. Tony wants him monitored and Hank wants a tranquilizer, and **Bruce hears them**.
- **The Hulk quits** and walks out into the night.
- In the North Atlantic, **Namor** has come back from decades of exile at sea. He's angry at the surface world and **recruits the Hulk**.
- **The Battle of Gibraltar:** the Avengers vs. the Hulk and Namor. The Hulk and Thor fight each other **to a standstill**, and the Hulk **leaps away** undefeated and alone.

- Furious, Namor comes across **Inuit hunters on the Greenland ice worshipping a figure frozen in a block of ice**. Disgusted, he **throws it into the sea**.
- The block drifts into the **Gulf Stream** and starts to thaw.
- The Avengers' submarine hauls it aboard. A man in a star-spangled uniform opens his eyes: "**BUCKY!**"
- **Captain America** wakes up in 2012, 67 years later.
- **Namor leads Atlantis** against **New York Harbor**. Within the hour, **Cap leads the Avengers** into battle.
- On a sinking pier, Cap faces his old Invaders comrade.

CAP: *"We fought side by side, Namor. Don't make me fight you now."*

- Namor looks at him for a long time. Then he **orders Atlantis to withdraw**.
- **Avengers Mansion, night**. Cap stands before the team. Fury gives him the shield, recovered from the sea floor. **The Avengers ask him to join**.
- The final rallying cry. Cap raises the shield: "**Avengers... ASSEMBLE!**"

EPILOGUE

- A dive bar in Brooklyn. **Claire Barton** and **Natasha Romanoff** watch the Avengers' first press conference on the TV above the bar.

CLAIRE: *"Think they're hiring?"*

NATASHA (sipping): *"Everyone's hiring. The question is whether they'll have us."*

5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

Field	Entry
When it's set	Monday, March 19, 2012 (the train) → Saturday, April 21, 2012 ("Avengers Assemble!"). The mid- and post-credit scenes are timeless.
Where it's set	The Isle of Silence · the Arizona desert · Asgard · Avengers Mansion, 890 Fifth Avenue, NYC · the Strait of Gibraltar · the Greenland ice sheet · the North Atlantic · New York Harbor (filmed on location in Gibraltar, Greenland/Iceland and New York)
Relative to other films	Five months after X-Men . Fury's briefing file includes the San Marco footage. Cap has been in the ice sixty-seven years (April 1945 to April 2012).

6. WORLD-BUILDING

The film's own world

- **The Avengers:** the name, the Mansion, Jarvis, the S.H.I.E.L.D. charter, and "**Avengers Assemble!**"
- **The team's weak point is trust.** The Hulk leaves, and the team doesn't forget it.
- **Cap as leader.** A man out of time leads a team from a century he doesn't recognize.

World-building for the wider MCU

Seed	How it appears	Payoff
The Hulk goes solo	He leaves the team (#3)	The Hulk's Phase 2 film
Namor and Atlantis	Atlantis is a world power now	Namor's Phase 2 story
Kooky Quartet	The Claire and Natasha epilogue; the Maximoff twins are out there too	Avengers #16 (Phase 2)
The Cosmic Cube	Fury's briefing: " <i>A.I.M.'s lab in Maryland went dark last week. Whatever they were building is gone.</i> "	Phase 2
The Winter Soldier	Cap asks Fury what happened to Bucky. Fury lies: " <i>We never found him.</i> "	Phase 2

Setting up the Big Bad

Seed	How it appears	What it means
The Phase 1 final shot	The post-credit scene	Thanos revealed
Death, in the open	For the first time, Death is shown clearly , beside Thanos. The hooded woman from <i>Iron Man</i> and <i>Captain America</i> is named on screen.	Fans go back through Phase 1 and find her .

7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

Field	Entry
Mid-credit scene	✓ "THE DESERT." Night in the New Mexico desert. The Hulk sits alone on a rock looking at the stars. Rick Jones walks up and sits beside him without a word. RICK: "They'll come around." HULK: "Hulk doesn't need them." (long beat) HULK: "...Stay." Rick stays.
Post-credit scene	✓ "COURTSHIP." A dead world under a black sun. A massive throne of stone. A figure sits on it with his back to us. A robed servant bows: "The humans have assembled, master. Heroes. Gods among them. To challenge them..." A purple hand rises, wearing a plain golden glove with six empty settings. The figure turns: THANOS. He looks past the servant to a pale woman in a dark hooded cloak, Mistress Death, who stands silently at his side. THANOS (smiling at her): "...is to court Death." She doesn't answer. CUT TO BLACK. "THE AVENGERS WILL RETURN."
Secret shoot codenames	Mid-credit: " CAMPFIRE. " Post-credit: " FIRST DATE. "

CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scenes · [x] The film's own world-building · [x] MCU world-building · [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline · ✓ Thanos cast (Josh Brolin)